THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 7 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 5: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A historian finds iron tools and punch-marked coins in a layer of a town. This suggests 1

(a) Gupta rule
(b) Mughal settlement
(c) agricultural growth and trade in the Second Urbanisation
(d) Harappan settlement

2. If a city lies at the meeting of rivers, its likely advantage is 1

(a) no trade **(b)** no people
(c) desert climate **(d)** transport and fertile land

3. Two mahajanapadas both control iron mines. The more likely outcome is 1

(a) rivalry to control routes and resources **(b)** peace without rivalry
(c) no trade **(d)** no war

4. An assembly chooses the head of state in an early republic. This shows 1

(a) foreign rule **(b)** colonial rule
(c) collective decision making **(d)** hereditary rule

5. Which of these is a reason for the rise of new religions in this period? 1

(a) questioning of rituals and social change **(b)** no change
(c) no cities **(d)** no trade

6. Which fact weakens the claim that early republics were fully democratic? 1

(a) women ruled
(b) all adults voted
(c) no assembly
(d) participation was limited to a certain group

7. Which clue best indicates a city's role as a trade centre? 1

(a) no walls **(b)** many coins and goods from distant places
(c) farm tools only **(d)** large forests

8. Which is a likely effect of coinage on tax systems? 1

(a) easier assessment and collection **(b)** more barter
(c) no records **(d)** no taxes

9. An inscription lists guilds donating to a monastery. This shows 1

(a) economic strength of guilds and patronage
(b) foreign rule
(c) decline of trade
(d) no guilds

10. Which factor most explains Magadha's military edge? 1

(a) no iron **(b)** no army
(c) bronze tools **(d)** iron weapons and elephants

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How did coins affect taxation? 2

12. How did trade routes create cities? 2

13. Why is the term 'urbanisation' used for this period? 2

14. Why is archaeology needed in addition to texts? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate the importance of iron in state formation. 3

16. Analyse the effects of surplus on society. 3

17. Analyse why Taxila and Pataliputra were important in different ways. 3

OR

Analyse why the republican system declined. 3

18. Examine how rivers shaped the location of capitals. 3

OR

Compare life in villages and cities in the period. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Critically examine how iron, trade and coins together transformed the Ganga plains into a centre of cities and states. 5

OR

Evaluate the role of religion and philosophy in the political and social life of the time. 5

20. Evaluate the nature of governance in monarchies and republics in the sixteen mahajanapadas. 5

OR

Discuss the importance of trade routes, markets and guilds in sustaining cities. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks